

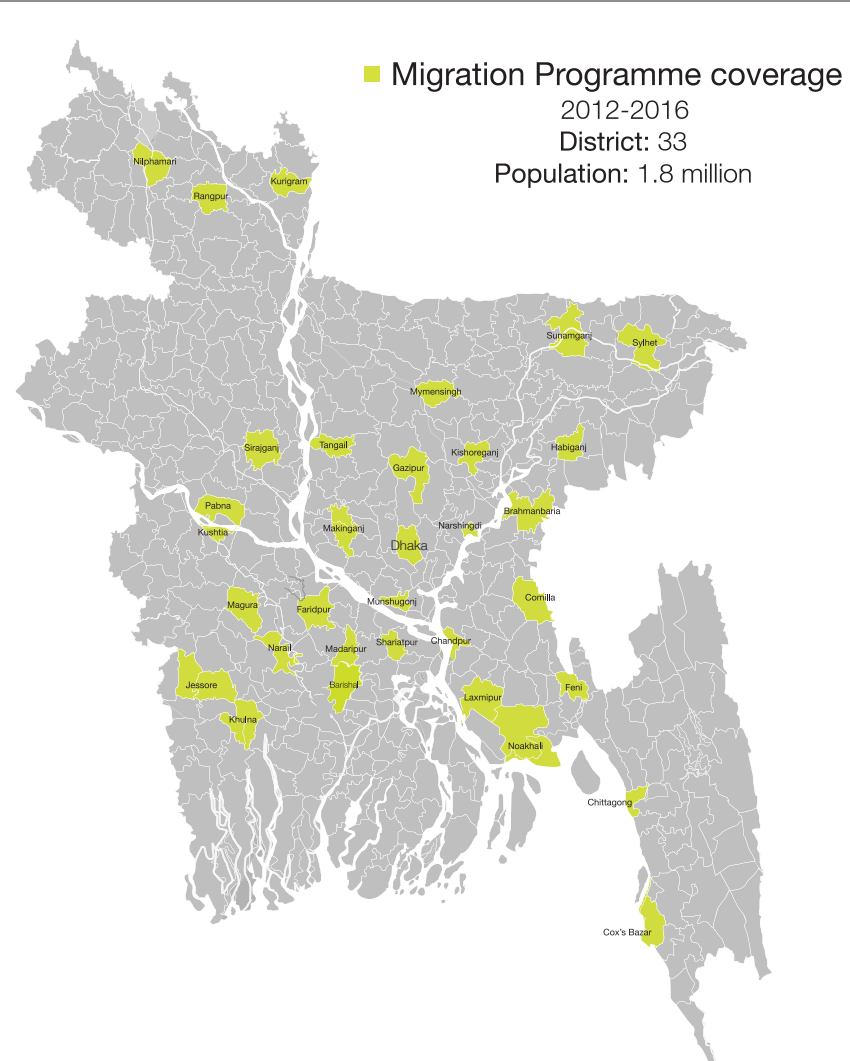


Establishment of reintegration and referral services for returnee migrant workers

The Establishment of Reintegration and Referral Services for Returnee Migrant Workers project is funded by UN Women. The project's aim is to promote and protect rights of returnee migrant workers, particularly women and vulnerable men. The project targets three districts of Bangladesh that are prone to have more women migrants. The project will establish actions for reintegration, referral services for activating provisions of reintegration, and referral services for vulnerable returnee migrants, especially women. Additionally, the project will develop networks and build the capacity of government, NGO and private sector groups in order to effectively and efficiently provide socio-economic reintegration support.

Advocacy, networking and partnership

Migration programme is working to establishing a platform where all migrant organisations (NGOs, CBOs, migration forum) will be working actively to protect the rights of migrant workers from grassroots to regional level. At the grassroots level, the programme has developed partnership with 80 CBOs and local NGOs. At the national level, the National Alliance for Migrants Rights, Bangladesh (NAMR, B), a network comprising of various NGOs, is coordinating the advocacy initiatives from community to national level to international level. Regionally, the migration programme is an active member of CARAM Asia addressing migration-related issues at destination countries.



Currently migration programme's projects are funded by the Japan Social Development Fund (JSDF), (a trust fund managed by the World Bank), UKaid and AusAID (under the strategic partnership agreement with BRAC) and UN Women Bangladesh. Manusher Jonno Foundation, ILO, GTZ and Winrock International provided support to previous projects of BRAC.

Way forward

BRAC is carrying out a research on migration, specially focused on reintegration, skill development and women's migration. BRAC plans to include intensive safe migration facilitation and advocacy initiatives at all of the 64 districts to ensure safe migration and an enabling environment for migrant workers and their families. BRAC also plans to initiate a countrywide safe migration programme for internal female migrants.



BRAC
BRAC Centre
75 Mohakhali
Dhaka-1212
Bangladesh

Tel: +880 2 9881265
Email: info@brac.net

Follow us:





Migration and Bangladesh

BRAC's migration programme envisaged to ensure the rights of Bangladeshi migrants by providing an easy access to services that help them avoid exploitation. The underlying causes are limited access to information, inadequate services from agencies at all levels, and lack of proactive policymaking and implementation. BRAC's migration programme started in 2006, in 36 sub-districts with a pilot of Safe Migration Facilitation Centre project. Now it has expanded its operation in 124 sub-districts at 33 districts.

Programme goal

The goal of this programme is to ensure improved livelihood of Bangladeshi migrant workers and their family members through human rights promotion and protection.

Programme objectives

- To ensure safe migration of Bangladeshi migrant workers by raising awareness and migration education
- To reduce social vulnerabilities of migrants and their family members through increased access to essential information and services
- To facilitate socioeconomic reintegration of returnee migrant workers after their return to home
- To influence migration policies and procedures through advocacy, networking and media mobilisation
- To promote innovation and best practices for improving safe migration from Bangladesh

Programme approach

- Support migrant workers to raise their voice to claim their rights through building community pressure groups
- Facilitate civil society movements at national and sub-national level to harmonise migrant's demands to protect their rights
- Reinforce government for regional and global level negotiation for migrants' rights and networking for migration promotion from Bangladesh

Programme intervention

BRAC's interventions are designed at three stages.

a. Pre-migration

BRAC raises awareness on safe migration process at the pre-migration stage. The programme facilitates the formation of migration forums at grassroots level, formed with returnee migrants, teachers and volunteers. These forums provide social arbitration and legal aid support to the migrants. The programme helps migrants to understand the necessity of documented migration and the adverse effects of undocumented migration. The programme provides information and referral services for migration loan, skill training, language training and helps in checking visas. The programme also provides pre-decision orientation for potential migrants and pre-departure orientation for departing migrants.

b. On migration

BRAC also liaises with relevant ministries to influence respective Bangladeshi missions abroad for welfare support of the migrants during the 'on migration' period. BRAC networks with international organisations based on migrant's rights to provide support for migrants. BRAC also helps to rescue migrants to return safely with the support of the Bangladesh government and other international agencies.

c. Return and reintegration

BRAC migration programme works to create an enabling environment for migrant workers and their families for social and economic reintegration. BRAC facilitates and strengthens community-based support groups, forums and volunteers at community level to help returnee migrants and their families for social reintegration. BRAC also facilitates proper network skill utilisation of the returnee migrants for income-generating activities. Reintegration component of BRAC is more focused on female and vulnerable male migrants.

Ongoing projects

Safe migration for Bangladesh migrant workers project

Safe migration for Bangladesh migrant workers project is funded by UKaid and AusAID under the strategic partnership agreement (SPA). The project aims to raise awareness at community level through courtyard meetings, interactive popular theatre (IPT) shows, pala gaan (folk song), community meetings, video shows, school/college quizzes, pre-decision orientation, etc. The project is facilitating the formation of migration forum and language learning forum. The project is also developing community-based volunteers. The migration forums work as community pressure groups, arrange social arbitration, and take necessary steps to realise compensation for the deceived migrants from the middlemen. Cases of forgery by middlemen and recruiting agencies are forwarded by Safe Migration Facilitation Centers to Bureau of Manpower, Employment and Training (BMET).

Safe migration for Bangladeshi workers project

BRAC's Safe Migration for Bangladeshi Workers project is funded by Japan Social Development Fund (JSDF) and managed by World Bank. The project aims to reduce vulnerability of the migrants and their family members, reducing dependency of migrants on middlemen by establishing and strengthening community-based organisations (CBOs) and local NGOs. The project provides capacity building support to the CBOs and NGOs to provide knowledge, information, and professional/life skills to potential migrants, as well as assist families of migrants in remittance management. A resource pool of volunteers is also developed under the project to ensure outreach information dissemination. The activities under the project thus help to support and formalise local networks and aim to demonstrate the value of disseminating information and strategies to reduce the risks of migration.



Migration Programme: **Fact Sheet**

Safe Migration Facilitation Centre (SMFC)

October 2006 - June 2014

Geographical coverage	124 Sub-districts of 33 districts
Established safe migration facilitation centre (SMFC)	15
Selected community based organization (CBO) for partnership	80

Activities	Population reached
Interactive popular theatre (IPT) shows	878,589
<i>Palasongs</i> (folk song shows) at urban areas	7,142
Community, courtyard, campaign meetings	189,923
Pre decision orientation	17,030
Video shows at village bazaar (market)	553,059
Quiz contests at school/college	228,009
Visa checking support for potential migrants	2,875
Support on DEMO registration from SMFCs	4,705

Community institution building and skills enhancement training

Migration forums	504
Migration journalist forums	3
Returnee migrants forums	3
Youth groups formation for safe migration	3
Need based skill training referral support provided to potential migrants	588
Trained volunteers	1,440

Social and Legal aid Support

Counseling support provided to returnee migrants (Libya Returnee)	13,182
Money recovery support for migrants provided by SMFC	606
Provided support for victims on Legal Aid Service at SMFC	109
Number of support to get compensation paid for accidental death	70
Money recovery support for migrants provided by SMFCs	BTD 25,435,000

Policy Advocacy Intervention

Union / ward level workshop and dialogue	421
Sub-district level workshop/ dialogue	175
District level workshop/ dialogue	52
Divisional level workshop/ dialogue	6
National level workshop / dialogue	6
International Migrants Day observation	7
Press conference	4